Same Leading Candidates, Different Tail Leakage

The two leading probabilities are identical; only the remaining mass moves from ranks 3–5 into the tail.

Identical in both examples — PO 0.38 | po 0.26 | top-2 mass = 64%

A · Remaining mass stays near the head

The remaining 36% is allocated to:

Ranks 3–5: 0.15 + 0.10 + 0.08 → Tail mass: 3%

Full probability mass



top-5 retained mass 97% | tail leakage 3%

97% remains in the top-5

B · Remaining mass escapes to the tail

The remaining 36% is allocated to:

Ranks 3–5: 0.05 + 0.05 + 0.04 → Tail mass: 22%

Full probability mass



top-5 retained mass 78% | tail leakage 22%

Tail leakage rises from 3% to 22%

PO and po look equally strong in both cases; 19 percentage points moving into the tail reveals the confidence drop.

Illustrative distributions; each row sums to 1.00.